



FARRAGUT IN ABOUT 1840

- **1854-58** Establishes the Navy Yard at Mare Island, California, as a facility for ship repair on the West Coast; promoted to captain (September 1855).
- **April 18, 1861** The day after Virginia's secession, Farragut, choosing to stay loyal to the Union, leaves Norfolk for New York.
- **January 9, 1862** Given command of the West Gulf Blockading Squadron with orders to capture New Orleans.
- **April 24-25, 1862** Farragut's squadron defies the guns of the Mississippi forts and fights through to New Orleans; this feat wins him promotion to rear admiral, a rank not previously accorded in the U.S. Navy.
- **June-July 1862** Farragut's squadron takes part in an unsuccessful attempt to reduce the Confederate fortress at Vicksburg by naval action.
- **March 14, 1863** Fails to coordinate effectively with Union land forces in the attack on Port Hudson on the Mississippi.